

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Bally's amends filing for casino public offering

Executives say IPO will still meet city's requirement for women, minorities

By Robert Channick
Chicago Tribune

Bally's Chicago has filed an amended registration with the Securities and Exchange Commission for its stalled initial public offering, opening up the investment opportunity beyond women and minorities.

Casino executives remain confident the IPO, which was challenged by two federal lawsuits over alleged discrimination against white men, will pass muster with regulators and still meet the city's 25% minority investment requirement for Bally's Chicago. "Thousands of qualified minorities have already applied," said

Chris Jewett, Bally's senior vice president of corporate development. "We're going to meet the goal." Bally's Chicago launched the \$250 million IPO in January exclusively for women and minorities to buy a 25% equity stake in the casino, looking to fulfill a commitment to the city and raise money for the construction of its planned \$1.7 billion entertainment complex in River West. Chicago-based Loop Capital

Markets serves as the lead placement agent for the IPO, which initially was limited to Blacks, Asian Americans, Hispanics and other "socially disadvantaged" people as defined by city guidelines. "As the lead placement agent for the Bally's Chicago IPO, we've seen interest from thousands of people who appreciate having access to this unique investment opportunity in a one-of-a-kind casino and resort project in the city of

Chicago," Jim Reynolds, CEO of Loop Capital Markets, said in a news release announcing the amended registration. While the IPO generated applications from thousands of women and minority investors who opened and funded accounts to buy shares in the city's first casino, the SEC did not declare the registration effective before the prospectus financials lapsed, **Turn to Bally's, Page 2**

Lawmakers in Illinois weigh ban on plastics

Bill would phase out single-use bags, most foam food containers

By Addison Wright
Chicago Tribune

After more than a decade of negotiations and failed efforts to reduce the use of plastics, Illinois lawmakers are considering legislation that would prohibit large retailers from offering single-use plastic bags and ban the use of most polystyrene containers in the state over the next four to five years. Advocates, citing the threat of rising plastic waste to human and environmental health, say the timing for the bills is ripe given rising health concerns about microplastics and the passage of similar legislation in states like New Jersey and California. Retailers also support the measures, calling the requirements balanced and flexible, according to a statement from the Illinois Retail Merchants Association. But at the same time, President Donald Trump's administration is moving in an opposite direction, with Trump declaring America is going "back to plastic" by reversing federal restrictions on plastic drinking straws and dismantling departments that regulate plastic pollution. In addition, some labor unions, including the Illinois Pipe Trades Association and AFL-CIO, oppose the move to do away with foam food containers. Manufacturers have expressed concerns the measures could lead to thousands of layoffs if the facilities

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Pritzker dismisses GOP accusations

Gov. JB Pritzker rejected accusations from Republicans that he was inciting violence with a fiery speech in New Hampshire in which he said Republicans shouldn't "know a moment of peace." **Chicagoland, Page 3**

'Empire' mansion sells for \$6.5 million

The lavish Barrington Hills mansion that for six seasons appeared on the hit Fox TV series "Empire" sold for far below its original asking price. **Business**

Cardinals schedule conclave for May 7

Catholic cardinals set May 7 as the start date for the conclave to elect Pope Francis' successor, delaying the secret voting for two days. **Nation & World**



TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Downtown curfew changes still on table

Chicago police officers post up outside the AMC River East 21 theater on Illinois Street on April 18. An ordinance introduced by Ald. Brian Hopkins, 2nd., proposes to give police brass the power to declare curfews when mass teen gatherings are expected or ongoing. On Monday, Mayor Brandon Johnson was hesitant about giving the police the power to declare "snap" curfews. **Page 2**



Kobie Robinson Jr., 13, conducts a buoyancy test Saturday during a lesson with the Chicago Pre-College Science and Engineering Program at Kenwood Academy. **AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

The engines of change

Chicago program puts young minds on the fast track to STEM

By Nell Salzman
Chicago Tribune

Growing up in Englewood, Soyini Walton said she was directed into transcription and stenography classes while she watched her male peers walk around with slides and discuss algebra. She always preferred science but said she wasn't given the option to pursue it. At age 11, she remembers finding a dead bird

and, out of curiosity, cutting it open with her dad's razor. "Nobody really said, Well, what are you passionate about? Because you probably could go into anything you want," Walton said. She worked as a teacher for years in her 20s before returning to Richard J. Daley and Kennedy-King colleges on the Southeast Side to enhance her math knowledge. Now, almost 80, she sets an

example teaching earth science and algebra classes at the Chicago Pre-College Science and Engineering Program, also known as ChiS&E, a nonprofit that offers enrichment classes on Saturdays and in the summer for historically underrepresented students to pique and motivate their interest in careers in science. The program began serving

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White House leans on border effort

At 100 days, policy on migrants strong, but poll results weak

By Michelle L. Price
and Chris Megerian
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — The White House on Monday opened a weeklong celebration of President Donald Trump's first 100 days in office by focusing on his border ■ Where crackdown, an area of relative strength for his administration at a time when there are red flags for him in the latest round of polling. Yard signs with mugshots of immigrants who have been accused of crimes like rape and murder were posted across the White House lawn, positioned so they would be in the background of television broadcasts outside the West Wing. Tom Homan, Trump's top border adviser, told reporters that there has been "unprecedented success" on the border effort and "we're going to keep doing it, full speed ahead."

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